DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL JANKIPURAM, LUCKNOW
PREBOARD-II
SESSION 2025 - 2026
ENGLISH LANGUAGE AND LITERATURE (184)

SET I

MM: 80

Time:3 Hrs

Date: 10/1/26 Name Mohd. Hifzaan Khan Class: X Sec: D

General Instructions:

(i) The question paper is divided into three sections:
Section A: Reading (20 marks)
Section B: Writing and Grammar (20 marks)
Section C: Literature (40 marks)

(ii) All questions are compulsory.

(iii) You may attempt any section at a time.

(iv) All questions of that particular section must be attempted in the correct order.

SECTION A: READING (20 MARKS)

1. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow: 10

1. Experts say that what customers buy in the name of herbal cosmetics is often a synthetic cosmetic with an herb or two added, which works to lure customers. A product that says it is 100% natural may be misleading in the sense that it is difficult to stabilize a fully-natural base and is always quite expensive, requiring advanced technology. The desired shelf-life of a product is expected to be at least two years, but that of a purely herbal product would be restricted to about six months. Also, the product won't be as aesthetically appealing as the synthetic product. Hence, manufacturers of herbal products have to include synthetic-based ingredients to balance the formula.
2. Herbal ingredients might also cause allergies as they may contain a large number of constituents which a user may be intolerant to.
3. According to the law experts, a customer suing someone is considered extreme. Given the legal system in India and the long-drawn litigation processes, most consumers tend to pursue legal action against manufacturers or distributors in the event of a problem. However, with the dawn of consumer forums and more effective laws, protecting the interests of the consumers, the trend is slowly moving towards this direction.
4. At times, it is not just manipulative manufacturers and passive consumers, but weak and absent rules regarding the process of manufacturing leading to fake production licenses. Also, one cannot make a generalisation that synthetic ingredients are safe while natural ones are harmful. I would say that the difference is that, if one is a known devil (synthetic), then the other is unknown. Unlike the case of synthetic cosmetics, herbal cosmetics are in a nascent stage as there are no well-defined standards for the use of raw materials in the production of herbal cosmetics.
5. Customers can check the ingredients in a cosmetic product by using the 'Cosmetics Ingredient Dictionary', a database of 19,000 ingredients. It claims to help users check out what chemical compounds they use daily.

On the basis of your reading of the passage, answer the following questions:

1. "A product that says it is 100% natural may be misleading." Explain. (2)

2 Fill in the blanks: (1)

There are no well-defined standards for the use of _____ in the production of herbal cosmetics.

3 What leads to fake production licences? (2)

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

4. Cosmetics Ingredient Dictionary is a database of 3,000 ingredients. (True/False) (1)

5. Cosmetics Ingredient Dictionary claims to help users check: (1)

(i) what chemical compounds they use daily (ii) the use of raw materials

(in) consumer forums (iv) productions of herbal cosmetics

6. Based on your reading of the passage, choose the INCORRECT statement from the following (1)

(i) Herbal ingredients might also cause allergies.

(ii) According to the law experts, a customer suing someone is common.

(iii) Manufacturers of herbal products have to include synthetic-based ingredients to balance the formula.

(iv) The desired shelf-life of a product is expected to be at least two years.

7. Choose the option that correctly states the two meanings of **'nascent'**, as used in the passage to fill in the blank space. (1)

(1) Displaying (2) Developing (3) Maturing

(4) Growing (5) Confirmed

(i) (1) and (2) (ii) (3) and (5)

(iii) (1) and (5) (iv) (2) and (4)

8. "Herbal ingredients might also cause allergies as they may contain a large number of constituents which a user may be <u>intolerant</u> to." Substitute the underlined word with the most appropriate option from the following. (1)

(i) Sensitive (ii) Forgiving (ii) Flexible (iv) Liberal

2. Read the passage given below and answer the questions that follow: 10

1. In the Vedic period, women had access to education in India, but it gradually declined. However, there was a revival of interest in women's education in India later. Eminent personalities like Raja Ram Mohan Roy and Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar laid great stress on women's education. Mahatma Jyotiba Phule, Periyar and Baba Saheb Ambedkar also took the initiative towards spreading of women's education.

2. Women's employment and education was acknowledged in 1854 by the East India Company's Programme called Wood's Dispatch. There was progress in female education and the literacy rate for women increased from 0.2% in 1882 to 6% in 1947.

3. Jyotiba Phule and his wife were pioneers in female education as they started a school for girls in 1848 in Pune. In 1878, the University of Calcutta became one of the first universities to admit female graduates to its degree programmes.

4. In 1947, after India became independent, the University of Education Commission was set up to devise ways to improve the quality of education. In 1958, a national committee on women's education was appointed by the government. Most of its recommendations were accepted and female education got equal importance as boys. The Education Commission, which was set up in 1964, recommended a national policy to be developed by the government with emphasis on female education.

5. Under the 86th Constitutional Amendment, elementary education is a fundamental right for children between 6 and 14 years of age. The government has undertaken to provide this free of cost and made it compulsory, and it is known as Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan. Some schemes are Mahila Samakhya Programme and National Programme for Education of Girls at Elementary Level.

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

On the basis of your reading of the passage, answer the following:

1. Which university was the first to admit female graduates to its degree programmes? (1)

(i) University of Calcutta (ii) University of Delhi

(iii) University of Education Commission (iv) University of Chennai

2. How did the Indian government promote women's education after independence? Answer in about 40 words (2)

3. What is the correct order of the information given below:

I. Female education got equal importance as boys.

II. Literacy rate for women increased from 0.2% in 1882 to 6% in 1947.

III. There was a revival of interest in women's education in India.

IV. Elementary education is a fundamental right for children between 6 and 14 years of age. (1)

(1) III, I, II, IV (ii) III, II, I, IV

(iii) I, IV, II, III (iv) II, I, III, IV

4. Give a textual reference from the passage to support the idea that Jyotiba Phule and his wife were pioneers in female education. (2)

5. What is the fundamental right for children between 6 and 14 years of age under the 86th constitutional amendment? (1)

(i) Female education (ii) Women employment

(iii) Elementary education (iv) Girl's literacy

6. Fill in the blank. (1)

The first national committee on women's education set up in 1958

7. A pioneer in female education who started a school for girls in 1848 in Pune was Raja Ram Mohan Roy. (True/False) (1)

8. Identify the word from the extract that means the same as *"people who start or lead new initiatives"*. (1)

(i) Dispatch (ii) Graduates (iii) Pioneers (iv) Committee

SECTION B: GRAMMAR AND CREATIVE WRITING (20MARKS)

3. **Complete ANY TEN of twelve of the following tasks, as directed.** (1X10=10)

1. **Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a diary entry.**
   Date: 12th August, 2025
   Today was a memorable day. Our team finally _____ (win) the inter-school football championship after weeks of hard work and practice.
2. **Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the slogan by a Road Safety Campaign.**
   _____ YOU TEXT AND DRIVE? THINK TWICE!
   (a) CAN (b) SHOULD (c) MUST (d) WILL
3. **Fill in the blank:**
   The farmer distributed free vegetables _____ the flood-affected villages.
4. **Identify the error in the following line from a news report and supply the correction:**
   When she returned to her flat, she saw at once that the burglars broke in her absence.

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

error	correction

5. **Supply a suitable verb in the blank given below:**
Either of the two girls _____ willing to volunteer for the debate.
6. **Complete the blank by filling a suitable determiner from the given options:**
We looked for a water bottle, but there was not _____ left in the fridge.
(a) many (b) some (c) any (d) much
7. **Identify the error in the following line from a survey conducted by a marketing company and supply the correction:**

According to the survey results, 68% of respondents says they prefer shopping online due to better discounts and convenience.

error	correction

8. **Fill in the blank by choosing the correct option, to complete the statement of a Climate Activist.**
Governments _____ take stronger measures to reduce carbon emissions.
(a) may (b) could (c) must (d) should
9. **Supply a suitable verb in the given sentence:**
Spreading rumours and fake news on social media _____ harmful for society.
10. **Fill in the blank with the correct option:**
Neither of the two books _____ been issued from the library.
(a) have (b) has (c) were (d) are
11. **Fill in the blank by using the correct form of the word in the bracket, for the given portion of a complaint letter:**
Subject: Delay in train services
I wish this complaint _____ (bring) timely action from the concerned authorities.
12. **Complete the given narrative by supplying a suitable determiner:**
Riya solved all the questions in the test without _____ difficulty.

(CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS)

4. **Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below.** (5)

(A) You are Sunidhi/Sunil, a resident of Mayur Vihar, Delhi. You are deeply concerned about the growing trend of 'Digital Isolation' among teenagers in your locality, where young people spend excessive time on social media instead of engaging in physical sports or face-to-face social interactions. Write a letter to the Editor of The Daily Mirror, highlighting the psychological impact of this trend and suggesting ways to encourage a healthier lifestyle.

OR

(B) You are Tanvi/Tanishq, the Secretary of the Science Club at Bal Bharati Public School, Rohini. Your school is planning an educational excursion to the Nehru Planetarium and the National Science Centre in New Delhi for 50 students of Class X. Write a letter to the Manager of 'Travel India Tours & Travels' enquiring about their tour packages. Ask about the charges, transportation, refreshments, and any group discounts available. (100–120 words)

5. **Attempt ANY ONE from A and B given below.** (5)

(A) The following table compares two holiday packages offered by a travel agency. Write an analytical paragraph in 100–120 words by analyzing the data and suggesting which package is more suitable for a budget-conscious family of four who enjoys nature and relaxation.

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

Feature	Package A: "Urban Retreat"	Package B: "Nature's Lap"
Location	City Center (Dubai)	Hill Station (Munnar)
Duration	4 Nights / 5 Days	6 Nights / 7 Days
Total Cost	₹1,50,000	₹85,000
Activities	Shopping, Nightlife, Theme Parks	Trekking, Tea Garden Tour, Spa
Stay	5-Star Hotel (Luxury)	Boutique Resort (Comfort)
Transport	Private Cabs	Sightseeing Coach

OR

(B)–Study the following flowchart which shows the impact of "Fast Fashion" on the environment. Write an analytical paragraph in 100–120 words, explaining the cycle and suggesting why a shift toward 'Sustainable Fashion' is necessary.

The Flowchart Content

Step 1: High Demand for Cheap Clothes → Mass Production in Factories.
Step 2: Use of Synthetic Fibers (Polyester) →High Carbon Emissions.
Step 3: Short Lifespan of Garments →Clothes discarded after 5-7 wears.
Step 4: Landfill Accumulation →Non-biodegradable waste + Water pollution from dyes.

SECTION – C- (LITERATURE TEXT BOOK)

6. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given. **5**

(A) *I learned that courage was not the absence of fear, but the triumph over it. The brave man is not he who does not feel afraid, but he who conquers that fear. No one is born hating another person because of the colour of his skin, or his background, or his religion. People must learn to hate, and if they can learn to hate, they can be taught to love, for love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite."*

(Nelson Mandela- Long Walk to Freedom)

1. Which of the following best defines 'courage' according to Mandela? **1**
a) Living a life without any fear or danger.
b) Having the strength to ignore one's fears.
c) Overcoming and defeating one's fear.
d) Being born with a fearless personality.

2. "People must learn to hate..." In this context, Mandela suggests that hate is: **1**
a) An innate human quality.
b) An acquired behavior.

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

c) A necessary emotion for revolution.
d) A natural reaction to oppression.

3. Select the option that correctly uses the word 'triumph' as used in the passage. 1

a) The team celebrated their triumph over the defending champions.
b) He tried to triumph the stairs despite his injury.
c) It was a triumph of a day for a picnic.
d) She spoke in a triumph voice during the meeting.

4. How does Mandela justify that "love comes more naturally to the human heart than its opposite"? Support your answer with examples from the text. 2

OR

(B) *"When the train had gone, I found myself standing alone on the deserted platform. I had no idea where to spend the night. I had no friends, believing that friends were more trouble than help. And I did not want to make anyone curious by staying at one of the small hotels near the station. The only person I knew really well was the man I had robbed. Leaving the station, I walked slowly through the bazaar."*

(The Thief"s Story)

1. Why did Hari Singh hesitate to stay at a hotel? 1

a) He didn't have enough money to pay for a room.
b) He was afraid of being recognized or caught by the police.
c) He wanted to save the money he had stolen from Anil.
d) He felt guilty about spending Anil's hard-earned money.

2. What does the phrase "friends were more trouble than help" reveal about Hari Singh's character? 1

a) He was an introvert who hated socializing.
b) He was a seasoned thief who lived a life of isolation and distrust.
c) He had been betrayed by his friends in the past.
d) He was too busy with his work to maintain friendships.

3. Which of the following emotions best describes Hari's state of mind on the "deserted platform"? 1

a) Triumph and excitement.
b) Anger and resentment.
c) Loneliness and inner conflict.
d) Fear of the darkness.

4. Why did Hari Singh decide to go back to Anil despite having the money in his pocket?

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given. 5

(a) (I am an orphan, roaming the street.
I pattern soft dust with my hushed, bare feet.
The silence is golden, the freedom is sweet.)
Don't eat that chocolate, Amanda!
Remember your acne, Amanda!
Will you please look at me
when I'm speaking to you, Amanda!

(Amanda)

1. Why is the first stanza of the extract placed within brackets? 1

a) To show that these lines are a chorus in a song.
b) To indicate that these are Amanda's internal thoughts/daydreams.
b) To show that the speaker is whispering.
d) To mark the lines as less important than the instructions.

2. What does Amanda mean by "The silence is golden"? 1

a) She wants to find gold in the streets.
b) She finds the absence of her mother's nagging incredibly precious.
c) She is referring to the color of the sunset in her dream.
d) She wants to live in a quiet, wealthy neighborhood.

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

3. The mother's tone in the last three lines can best be described as: 1
a) Affectionate and caring.
b) Dominating and intrusive.
c) Indifferent and bored.
d) Encouraging and supportive.

4. Why does Amanda imagine herself to be an orphan? Does she really wish to be one? 2

OR

(b) All night the roots work
to disengage themselves
from the cracks in the veranda floor.
The leaves strain toward the glass
small twigs stiff with exertion
long-cramped boughs shuffling under the roof
like newly discharged patients
half-dazed, moving to the clinic doors.

(The Trees)

1. What does the "veranda floor" represent in the context of the poem? 1
a) A place of growth and natural beauty.
b) The natural habitat of the roots.
c) The restrictive, domestic boundaries of a house.
d) A sturdy foundation for the forest.

2. Which poetic device is used in "like newly discharged patients"? 1
a) Metaphor b) Simile c) Onomatopoeia d) Oxymoron

3. The phrase "stiff with exertion" suggests that the movement of the trees is: 1
a) Effortless and quick.
b) Forced and painful.
c) Calm and rhythmic.
d) Random and accidental.

4. How does the poet use the "roots" and "leaves" to depict a struggle for freedom? 2

8. Answer ANY FOUR of the following in 40- 50 words each: (3x4=12)

1. "Humanity still exists, but it often goes unrecognised." Explain this statement with reference to the role of the postmaster and his employees in the story "A Letter to God".
2. How did the Buddha use the analogy of the "ripe fruits" and "earthen vessels" to explain the nature of human life to Kisa Gotami?
3. How does the "locked cage" affect the tiger's natural instincts and behaviour, according to the poem " A Tiger in the Zoo"?
4. "The Proposal" is more of a quarrel about property and prestige than an affectionate union. Justify this statement with examples from the play.
5. "Paper has more patience than people." Elucidate this statement in the light of Anne Frank's decision to maintain a diary.

9. Answer ANY TWO of the following in 40- 50 words each: (3x2=6)

1. In 'The Making of a Scientist,' how did a simple hobby like butterfly collecting evolve into a ground breaking career in molecular biology?

Scanned with OKEN Scanner

2. How was Horace Danby tricked by the lady in red, and why did he not suspect that she was also a thief?

3. Why was Bholi's teacher different from everyone else at home, and how did her encouragement change Bholi's life?

10. Answer ANY ONE of the following in 100-120 words each: (1X6=6)

(A) Valli ,from 'Madam Rides the Bus' experiences the 'mystery of life and death' when she sees the dead cow, while Kisa Gotami ,from 'The Sermon at Benares' learns about the same truth through the Buddha's teachings. Compare their experiences—how does a young girl's realization differ from an adult's journey toward the same truth?

OR

(B) The three parts of 'Glimpses of India' show that India is a land of diverse traditions, from the Portuguese influence in Goa to the brave martial traditions of Coorg and the ancient legends of Assam. How do these distinct regional stories contribute to a single, rich picture of Indian heritage?

11. Answer ANY ONE of the following in 100-120 words each: (1X6=6)

(A) Imagine Ausable, the clever secret agent, is tasked with capturing the invisible Griffin. Ausable relies on his 'presence of mind' to defeat enemies, while Griffin relies on 'scientific power' to escape them. Based on their traits in the stories, who do you think would win this battle of wits, and what does this tell us about the true strength of a human being?

OR

(B) Both Tricki and Hari Singh are 'cured' not by medicine or punishment, but by a change in their surroundings. How does the 'practical treatment' given by Dr. Herriot compare to the 'silent trust' shown by Anil? Which do you think is a more effective way to change a person (or a pet) for the better?

Scanned with OKEN Scanner